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# How to use KeelRace

A click-by-click guide for architects. The first pass is seven pages, each finished before you leave it. Models may propose. You lock, cite, and approve. A confirmed decision becomes a standing rule the next change is checked against.

User guide · KeelRace workspace · Open from the sidebar as “User guide”

## What you will do

1. Sign in and create a project
2. Create a RequirementSet
3. Enter requirements — import or add one by one
4. Run critic and driver cards
5. Lock and generate on Requirements
6. Record quality rules
7. Attach the rules on Design Docs
8. Approve the map and the components
9. Prototype, skeleton, and zip
10. Snapshot and the architecture package
11. Library, standing rules, and change

> LampCheck (Demo project) and How this works are a filled example. Do not treat them as your architecture. Agent test is for a live project you own, not the demo.

## The seven pages

| | Page | On this page | Leave when |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Requirements | Lock the set, then generate the system map. | The map exists. |
| 2 | NFRs & Risk | Record the quality rules. | At least one rule is saved. |
| 3 | Design Docs | Attach those rules to the map. | Review is the next page. |
| 4 | Review Queue | Approve the map, then the component designs. | Both are approved. |
| 5 | Diagram / Traceability | Prototype, skeleton, then download the zip. | The files are listed. |
| 6 | Snapshots | Capture the structure you have now. | A snapshot exists. |
| 7 | Package | Read the rules in force, the retired rules, and the settled questions. Export. | You have the file. |

## 1. Sign in and create a project

1. Open KeelRace. If you are not signed in, click **Workspace** or go to **/login**.

2. Enter your email and password. Click **Sign in**. First visit: **Need an account? Sign up**, confirm email, then sign in.
3. You land on **Projects**. Click the blue **New project** button (top right).
4. In the dialog, type a name (your product, not “test”). Click **Create**.
5. The new row is clickable. Click the name. You are now in that project’s workspace.

1. **Continue to projects** — workspace if you already have an account.
2. **Open projects / Workspace** — same destination from the top bar.

1. Left rail: **Projects**, **Demo project**, **How this works**, **User guide** (this PDF).
2. **In order** — seven pages, once each: Requirements, NFRs & Risk, Design Docs, Review Queue, Diagram / Traceability, Snapshots, Package.
3. **New RequirementSet** — first click inside a new project.

## 2. Create a RequirementSet

1. On **Requirements**, click **New RequirementSet**.
2. A version chip appears, e.g. **v1 draft**. That is the working SRS. You can have several versions later; generation always uses a *locked* set.
3. Until it is locked you will see two ways to fill it: **Import from a document** and **Add one requirement manually**. You do not have to use both.

> The critic buttons stay disabled until a set exists. Create the set first, then run assist.

## 3. Enter requirements

Pick path A (import) or path B (type them). Mixing is allowed: import the bulk, then add the gaps by hand.

### Path A — Import from a document

1. Stay on Requirements with a **draft** set selected (not locked).
2. Find the card **Import from a document**.
3. Leave **Upload .docx/.pdf** selected, or click **Paste text** if you already copied the SRS.
4. Upload: click the file control, choose a **.docx** or **.pdf**. Paste: put the raw text in the box.
5. Click **Extract & parse**. Wait. You get a review list, nothing is saved yet.
6. For each row: keep or clear the checkbox; edit **Ref code** (FR-1, CON-1, NFR-A); set type **FR / NFR / CON**; fix title and body.
7. Click **Import N selected**. FR and CON become requirements on this set. NFRs go to the **NFRs & Risk** tab, not the FR list.

**What that card looks like**

Import from a document — already have an SRS? Bring it in instead of retyping.

Upload .docx/.pdf | Paste text

Choose File — no file chosen

Extract & parse

After extract you will see checkboxes, ref codes, type dropdowns, titles, bodies, then **Import N selected**.

### Path B — Add one by one

1. On the same draft set, scroll to **Add one requirement manually**.
2. In **Ref code** type `FR-1` (or CON-1, NFR-1). Keep the prefix consistent; the UI filters by FR / NFR / CON from this code.
3. In **Title** type a short name, e.g. `Turn the lamp on and off`.
4. In **Body** type the shall-statement. One demand per row. If you need “and also”, add a second requirement.
5. Click **Add**. The card appears in the list below.
6. Repeat for each FR, CON, and any NFR you want as a requirement row. Extra quality rules can wait for NFRs & Risk.
7. Pencil edits the row. Trash deletes it — only while the set is draft.

**Add one requirement manually**

Ref code e.g. FR-1.1 | Title

Body — the verifiable shall

Add

> After **Lock**, those fields disappear. You cannot silently edit a frozen SRS. Use **Changes & Signals**.

## 4. Critic and drivers (still draft or after lock)

You can run these as soon as the set has rows. They write proposals only.

1. On Requirements, in **Architect assist · propose only**, click **Run requirement critic**.

2. Read each finding. **Keep** if you agree. **Dismiss** if the model is wrong (compound CON that is really one constraint).
3. If the set is still draft and there is a rewrite: **Apply rewrite to draft** updates that requirement's body. You still own the wording.
4. Click **Propose driver cards**. Each card is stimulus / environment / response.
5. Click **Accept driver** for the ones that will shape the split. **Reject** scale-out or cloud if the SRS never asked.
6. Optional: paste workshop notes or attach a whiteboard photo, then **Stage notes**. Staging does not lock.

1. **User guide** — this PDF, always a new tab.
2. **Architect assist** — same helpers as on Requirements, plus candidates, Ask, ATAM, mappings.
3. **RAG sources already loaded** — expand a title to read the chunk. You do not upload a corpus to start.

## 5. Lock, then generate — still on Requirements

1. On the RequirementSet card, click **Lock**. The badge becomes locked. Generation is rejected until this succeeds.
2. On that same card, click **Generate HLD/LLD**. Wait until the system map exists. Leave Requirements only after that.
3. Critic findings and driver cards are proposals. Accept the drivers that match the SRS. Reject a split the requirements never asked for. They do not approve the map.

> This page is one visit: lock, then generate. The next page is NFRs & Risk.

## 6. Quality rules

1. Open **NFRs & Risk**.
2. Name: e.g. `Local secret storage`. Description: what must stay true. Scope: usually **Project-wide**.
3. Click **Add NFR**. Repeat for each quality rule.
4. If import already created NFR rows, use those. Do not add a second copy.

1. Open **NFRs & Risk**.
2. Fill **Name** and **Description**.
3. Click **Add NFR**. Uncited NFRs block Approve later unless you override in the open.

## 7. Design Docs — attach the rules, once

1. Open **Design Docs**. Read the system map.
2. Optional: **Propose 3 candidates**, select one baseline, discard the others, then run devil's advocate. A selected candidate is not an approved map. There is no quality score.

3. If a yellow box lists uncited quality rules, attach them to a decision, or record an override in the open.
4. Leave for **Review Queue**. Prototype and Skeleton are not on this page.

1. **Design Docs**.
2. **Propose 3 candidates** — before you treat one HLD as inevitable.
3. **Devil's advocate** — after a baseline exists (selected candidate or generated HLD).

> Generation uses accepted drivers and the selected candidate when those exist. It still does not approve the document.

## 8. Review — approve the map, then the components

1. Open **Review Queue**. Stay here until both approvals are done.
2. Read the system map. **Approve** when the split is good enough to be official. **Request changes** needs a comment. **Reject** when this generate should not be used.
3. If Approve fails, read the message: uncited quality rule, missing spike, unconfirmed reconciliation, or an option that breaks a standing rule.
4. A break stops approval until you rewrite the option, or you record a different decision that replaces the rule and you write why. The old rule stays in the ledger as replaced.
5. Approve the component designs on this same page. A model cannot set the status.

1. **Review Queue** — the only door to official.
2. **Attach HLD quality rules** if citations are missing.
3. **Approve the HLD** — a person, not the model.

## 9. Diagram — prototype, skeleton, zip

1. Open **Diagram / Traceability**. This is the only place Prototype and Skeleton are created.
2. Click **Prototype**. You get a flow of the approved map.
3. Click **Skeleton**. Stub files appear under each component, linked by component id. The filename is not the identity.
4. Click **Download zip** on the generation row.

## 10. Snapshot, then the package

1. Open **Snapshots**. Capture the structure you have now.
2. Open **Package**. Read the preview, then export.
3. The first section is what you are accountable for: each rule still in force, and each rule that was retired, with the reason.

4. Settled questions list the answer that won and the answers that were turned down. Language, database product, and hosting are decisions only if they appear there.

> The package is the brief you would defend in a review, and the list a later change is checked against. It is not a second copy of the screens you already clicked.

## What you click after approval

| Screen | What you click | What it is for |
|---|---|---|
| Diagram / Traceability | **Prototype**, then **Skeleton**, then **Download zip** | The flow, the stub files, and a folder you can keep. Files link by component id. |
| Snapshots | **Capture** | Freeze this structure so a later change can be compared. |
| Package | Read the preview, then export | Rules still in force, rules retired and why, then the settled questions. |
| ADR Ledger | Type the chosen option, confirm the sentence, the ending, and what it covers | A standing rule. The copilot does not choose the winner. |

## 11. Library — open it when the question shows up

Library is not another pass through the seven pages. Each item answers one later question.

| Open | When |
|---|---|
| ADR Ledger | You confirm a standing rule: one sentence, the only ending it allows, and what it covers. The copilot may list alternatives. You type the chosen option. |
| Evidence map | Someone asks why a component exists. The answer is requirement, then decision, then file. |
| Drift & Health | A file changed. It still holds a rule, or the change is architectural drift. |
| Changes & Signals | The locked set must grow. Door 1 is a requested add, modify, or remove. Door 2 is something found later. Apply creates a new requirement-set version. |
| Contracts, debt, governance, teams, members, audit | An API shape, work you are leaving on purpose, where it runs, who owns a component, who may approve, or a check that the links still point at each other. |

### When the SRS must change

1. Open **Changes & Signals**.

2. Door 1: fill Description. Action **add / modify / remove**. For modify/remove pick the target requirement. Proposed text if you have it. **Submit**.
3. Door 2: click **Door 2: Signals**, describe what you found, **Submit**, then classify (defect vs requirement gap).
4. Optional: **Write blast brief** — a narrative, not triage.
5. Scope → reconverge → apply. That creates a **new** requirement-set version. You do not unlock and overwrite.

1. **Changes & Signals**.
2. **Write blast brief** — impact story from the graph.
3. Door 1 form: description, add/modify/remove, proposed text, **Submit**.

## Rules that do not move

- Generate is rejected until the set is locked.
- Approve is a person. It can fail on an uncited quality rule, a missing spike, or an option that breaks a standing rule.
- Replacing a rule needs a different decision and a written reason. The old rule stays.
- Assist never sets approved or locked.
- Do not use a quality number as a gate.
- Do not treat a filename as a component.